AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

+27 76 757 5773
www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Shoprite Foundation (Shoprite Holdings Limited) × ASCO

Youth Community Skills and Participation Initiative

Requested CSI investment: R75,000

Proposed implementation area: An underserved South African school or community in a Shoprite operating area, with the exact municipality to be confirmed after local needs assessment and Shoprite route eligibility checks.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Shoprite Foundation (Shoprite Holdings Limited)** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Youth Community Skills and Participation Initiative**. The proposed request is **R75,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Youth Community Skills and Participation Initiative in An underserved South African school or community in a Shoprite operating area, with the exact municipality to be confirmed after local needs assessment and Shoprite route eligibility checks., benefiting Proposed direct beneficiaries: unemployed or under-resourced young people, approximately ages 15–34, with secondary beneficiaries including educators, caregivers and local community-based organisations; final cohort and safeguarding criteria to be defined by ASCO. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Shoprite Foundation (Shoprite Holdings Limited)'s publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R75,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Youth Community Skills and Participation Initiative

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
An underserved South African school or community in a Shoprite operating area, with the exact municipality to be confirmed after local needs assessment and Shoprite route eligibility checks.

Target beneficiaries
Proposed direct beneficiaries: unemployed or under-resourced young people, approximately ages 15–34, with secondary beneficiaries including educators, caregivers and local community-based organisations; final cohort and safeguarding criteria to be defined by ASCO.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: engage 60 young people in a structured community-development and participation programme over 6–9 months.
- Proposed: deliver at least 6 practical workshops covering civic participation, employability/digital or enterprise skills, and community problem-solving.
- Proposed: support youth-led teams to design and implement 3 small, locally relevant public-benefit actions, subject to safeguarding and site approval.
- Proposed: train 10 youth peer facilitators and provide attendance, pre/post learning and referral records.
- Proposed: produce one close-out report with participant demographics, outputs, lessons learned and expenditure evidence; these are targets, not completed results.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Shoprite Foundation (Shoprite Holdings Limited)?

A cautiously framed ASCO proposal could align if it presents a measurable community-development and youth-participation project in an underserved South African community where Shoprite operates, with practical youth skills, education, food-security or local-enterprise elements. A school- or community-based digital, agricultural or livelihood-readiness activity would be directionally consistent with the Foundation's published focus, but this is an inferred fit rather than evidence of Shoprite interest, eligibility approval or an existing partnership. ASCO should submit through the official donations route and explain its public-benefit outcomes, governance and safeguarding arrangements.

Verified company context

- The Shoprite Foundation was established in June 2022 and states that its core mandate is increasing equitable access to quality digital education for underserved schools across South Africa.
- The Foundation lists artificial intelligence, coding and robotics; agricultural tunnels; skills development; and educator training as core focus areas. It says these initiatives are intended to strengthen communities and help young people participate actively in their development.
- Shoprite's broader community strategy identifies food security and hunger relief, youth unemployment and skills development, education, and local entrepreneurship/enterprise supplier development as priority areas.
- The stated geography is South Africa for the Foundation's education mandate; Shoprite's donation guidance says supported organisations or programmes must benefit communities within which the Shoprite Group operates.
- Shoprite's official donations route requires all requests to be submitted through its website form. The guidance asks applicants to have details of the requested support, two organisational references, and —where applicable—a SARS PBO certificate and/or Department of Social Development NPO certificate.
- Shoprite says applications do not guarantee funding, organisations can be assisted only once per year, and event-related requests should be submitted 6–8 weeks beforehand. The FY2025 Integrated Report records R453 million of CSI spend into communities in South Africa, focused on hunger relief/food security, youth unemployment and local entrepreneurship.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R45,100	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R6,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R4,500	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R6,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R5,200	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R5,200	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R3,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R75,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R75,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Apply via Shoprite's official Donations and Sponsorships page: https://www.shopriteholdings.co.za/contactus/donations-and-sponsorships.html, using the linked form https://donations-and-sponsorships.bitrix24.site/. The reviewed official pages do not publish a Foundation-specific grant email or direct application contact. ASCO may retain its phone +27 76 757 5773 for its own proposal materials, but Shoprite says requests must use the online form.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- The official pages do not state that the Shoprite Foundation accepts unsolicited proposals specifically for a R75,000 grant; the confirmed route is Shoprite's general donations and sponsorship form.
- Funding is discretionary, high-volume, and not guaranteed; Shoprite says it cannot take requests by telephone, fax or mail and cannot confirm receipt/status telephonically.
- Shoprite excludes operational costs and salaries, political or religious organisations as direct beneficiaries, research/study tours, conferences/exhibitions, advertising/film/video projects, contests/pageants, and projects that do not benefit communities where the Group operates.
- The public sources reviewed do not provide a Foundation-specific application deadline, geographic shortlist, grant-size range, or assurance that ASCO's proposed activity would be funded.
- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.
- No completed ASCO results, Shoprite commitment, or existing partnership should be claimed.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Shoprite Foundation (Shoprite Holdings Limited)** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.shopriteholdings.co.za/sustainability/shoprite-foundation.html
2. https://www.shopriteholdings.co.za/sustainability/communities.html
3. https://www.shopriteholdings.co.za/contactus/donations-and-sponsorships.html
4. https://www.shopriteholdings.co.za/docs/shp-ir-2025.pdf

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.